

doc-spirit-personhood

Affirms · Pneumatology › Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

The Holy Spirit is a personal being (possessing intellect, will, and emotion), not an impersonal force or energy.

Rationale

Pan-canonical lexical demonstration. The personal title παράκλητος *paraklētos* G3875 ('advocate, helper, counselor') is applied to the Spirit four times in John (14:16, 14:26, 15:26, 16:7) and the same noun is used of Christ at 1 John 2:1, locking the term to personal agency. Jesus repeatedly couples it with the masculine demonstrative ἐκεῖνος *ekeinos* G1565 (John 14:26, 15:26, 16:8, 16:13-14) of grammatically-neuter πνεῦμα *pneuma* G4151, breaking grammatical agreement to assert personhood. Personal actions are predicated of the Spirit across the canon: teaches and reminds (John 14:26 *didaxei* G1321, *hypomnēsei* G5279), testifies (John 15:26 *martyrēsei* G3140), guides and speaks (John 16:13 *hodēgēsei* G3594, *lalēsei* G2980), glorifies (John 16:14 *doxasei* G1392), speaks in the first person and gives commands (Acts 13:2 *eipen* G2036 with dative *moi* G1473, aphorismate G873 imperative), exercises volition (1 Cor 12:11 *bouletai* G1014, 'as he wills'), intercedes with groanings (Rom 8:26-27 *hyperentugchanei* G5241, *stenagmois* G4726), can be grieved (Eph 4:30 *lypeite* G3076, an emotional response only a person can sustain), forbids and prevents (Acts 16:6-7 *kōlythentes* G2967, *ouk eiasen* G1439), and can be lied to (Acts 5:3-4 *pseusasthai* G5574, where Peter equates lying to the Spirit with lying to God).

Reasoning

Verdict: the Holy Spirit is a person, not a power, not an energy, and not a force. He has a mind that knows things, a will that chooses, and a heart that can be hurt. He is the third person of the Trinity, along with the Father and the Son. The strongest reason from Scripture is the way the Bible describes the Spirit doing things only a person can do. In John 14:26, Jesus says the Father will send 'the Helper, the Holy Spirit,' and that he will teach and remind. Teaching and reminding are personal actions. In John 16:13, Jesus says the Spirit 'will guide you into all the truth' and 'will speak.' Guiding and speaking are personal actions. In Acts 13:2, the church at Antioch hears the Holy Spirit speak directly: 'Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them.' The Spirit uses the word 'me' and 'I,' which is the speech of a person, not a force. In Romans 8:26 to 27, Paul writes that the Spirit 'intercedes for us with groanings too deep for words.' Interceding and groaning are things only a person does. In Ephesians 4:30, Paul writes, 'Do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God.' You cannot grieve an electric current or a wind. You can only grieve someone who has feelings. In 1 Corinthians 12:11, the Spirit gives gifts 'as he wills.' Willing is a personal act. In Acts 5:3 to 4, Peter tells Ananias that he lied to the Holy Spirit and that this is lying to God; you cannot lie to a force. The strongest counterargument is that the Greek and Hebrew words for 'spirit' (*pneuma* in Greek, *ruach* in Hebrew) can mean wind or breath, and the word in Greek is grammatically neuter, like an 'it' rather than a 'he.' Critics like Jehovah's Witnesses point to this to argue that the Spirit is impersonal energy. The verdict handles this two ways. First, the meaning of a word in any sentence is fixed by how it is used, not by what other things the word can mean elsewhere. The Bible uses the word 'spirit' with personal actions all over the New Testament, so in those places it carries a personal sense. Second, Jesus himself breaks Greek grammar to make the point. The Greek word for 'spirit' is neuter, but in John 14:26, 15:26, and 16:13 to 14, Jesus refers to the Spirit with a masculine 'he,' not a neuter 'it.' This grammatical mismatch is the New Testament's own way of insisting that the Spirit is a 'he,' not an 'it.' The doctrine is uncontested across historic Christianity.

Denominational landscape

Every major historic Christian lineage confesses the Holy Spirit as a distinct divine person, the third person of the Trinity. This was fixed at the First Council of Constantinople in AD 381, which expanded the Nicene Creed to confess the Holy Spirit as 'the Lord, the giver of life, who proceeds from the Father, who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified, who spoke through the prophets.' Patristic defenders include Basil of Caesarea (On the Holy Spirit), Athanasius (Letters to Serapion), Gregory of Nazianzus, and Gregory of Nyssa, who argued against the Pneumatomachi (the 'Spirit-fighters' who denied the Spirit's full deity and personhood). The Catholic Catechism, paragraphs 687 to 741, teaches that 'Holy Spirit is the proper name of the one whom we adore and glorify with the Father and the Son.' The Lutheran Augsburg Confession Article I confesses three persons of one essence, including the Holy Spirit. The Anglican 39 Articles, Article V, confesses the Holy Ghost as 'proceeding from the Father and the Son, of one substance, majesty, and glory with the Father and the Son, very and eternal God.' The Methodist Articles of Religion repeat the Anglican formula verbatim. The Reformed confessions (Westminster, Belgic, Heidelberg) all affirm the personal deity of the Spirit. Anabaptists in the Dordrecht Confession confess the Trinity. Pentecostals in the Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths teach the Holy Spirit as a divine person. Eastern Orthodoxy holds the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed at the center of its liturgy. There is no historic Christian tradition that denies this. Public-record carriers of denial are uniformly treated as outside historic Christianity. Jehovah's Witnesses teach the Holy Spirit as Jehovah's impersonal active force, an energy field rather than a person; their New World Translation and catechism are explicit on this. Christadelphians teach the Spirit as God's invisible power, not a distinct person. Unitarian Universalists hold no Trinitarian commitment at all. Iglesia ni Cristo denies the Trinity outright. Christian Science, founded by Mary Baker Eddy, treats Spirit as the divine principle rather than as a person. Some New Age and pantheistic systems conflate the Spirit with cosmic energy. These groups are classified by every tracked Christian lineage as denying a core boundary of the Christian confession, not as participating in an in-house dispute.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	Yes
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Personhood of the Holy Spirit is the second Trinitarian boundary alongside the Spirit's deity, fixed at Constantinople AD 381 (the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed expansion: the Spirit 'who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified'). The verdict rests on pan-canonical lexical demonstration. The personal noun *paraklētos* G3875 is applied to the Spirit; Jesus deliberately violates Greek grammatical agreement by referring to neuter *pneuma* with the masculine demonstrative *ekeinos*

G1565 (John 14:26, 15:26, 16:8, 16:13-14) to underscore personal identity. Pan-canonical personal predicates: teaches, reminds, testifies, guides, speaks, glorifies, wills, intercedes, groans, grieves, forbids, prevents, sends, calls, appoints. The Spirit speaks in the first-person voice at Acts 13:2 ('Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul'). Acts 5:3-4 equates lying to the Spirit with lying to God, treating the Spirit as both a person (capable of being deceived) and as God. Cult-marker-if-denied is canonically defensible because denying the Spirit's personhood denies the third person of the Trinity, which collapses historic Christian baptism (into the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, Matt 28:19) and the indwelling and witness of the Spirit that defines new-covenant Christian identity (Rom 8:9-16). Public-record carriers of denial: Jehovah's Witnesses (the Watchtower teaches the Holy Spirit as Jehovah's impersonal active force or energy; the New World Translation capitalizes 'holy spirit' inconsistently and the JW catechism explicitly denies the Spirit's personhood); Christadelphians (Spirit as God's invisible power, not a distinct person); Unitarian Universalists (no Trinitarian commitment at all); Iglesia ni Cristo (denies the Trinity, and accordingly denies the Spirit's distinct personhood); certain forms of Oneness Pentecostalism that collapse Father, Son, and Spirit into modes (this affects personhood-as-distinct rather than personhood-as-such); Christian Science under Mary Baker Eddy (Spirit as divine principle); New Age conflations of the Spirit with universal cosmic energy. All tracked historic Christian lineages treat the Spirit's personhood as non-negotiable. Fruit-vs-precision nuance: many believers describe the Spirit using less-than-precise language ('I felt the Spirit move,' 'the power of the Spirit'), but they pray to the Spirit, are sealed by the Spirit, hear the Spirit's voice, and are convicted by the Spirit, which is functional confession of personhood. The cult-marker line falls on denial of personhood as taught and held, not on imprecise devotional language.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. classical_trinitarianism, pneumatomachianism, modalism, jw_active_force_view

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

Competing lens verdicts

- affirms:
- denies_full_status:
- affirms_personhood_but_collapses_distinction:
- denies:

The verdict rests on a pan-canonical lemma network of personal predicates applied to pneuma. The personal title paraklētos G3875 is applied to the Spirit four times in John and to Christ at 1 John 2:1, locking the term to personal agency. The masculine demonstrative ekeinos G1565 is paired with neuter pneuma in John 14:26, 15:26, 16:8, 16:13-14, deliberately breaking grammatical agreement to assert personal identity. Personal-action verbs predicated of the Spirit across the canon: didaskō G1321 (teach), hypomimnēskō G5279 (remind), martyreō G3140 (testify), hodēgeō G3594 (guide), laleō G2980 (speak), doxazō G1392 (glorify), legō G3004 / eipō G2036 (speak), boulomai G1014 (will), eraunaō G2045 (search), oida G1492 (know), hyperentygchanō G5241 (intercede), lypeō G3076 (grieve), kōlyō G2967 (forbid), eaō G1439 (allow), agapaō G26 (love, via the noun agapē at Rom 15:30), enybrizō G1796 (insult), antiptō G496 (be resisted), blasphemēō G987 (be blasphemed against), pseudomai G5574 (be lied to). Personal nouns predicated of the Spirit: nous G3563 / phronēma G5427 (mind), agapē G26 (love), koinōnia G2842 (fellowship). The Acts 5:3-4 sequence equating lying-to-Spirit with lying-to-God simultaneously establishes personhood (capable of being lied to) and deity. Analogia scripturae integrates the apparently impersonal pour-out and quench-the-fire and wind-blows imagery as figurative descriptions of the personal Spirit's actions, not as descriptions of an impersonal substance. Progressive revelation: Gen 1:2 (the ruach Elohim hovering, an action verb of the Spirit) anticipates the personal agency that is then explicitly developed in the prophets (the Spirit speaking through them) and finally crystallized in John's Paraclete discourse and the Acts narrative. No non-default hermeneutic is required; grammatico-historical method on the canon itself is sufficient

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

John.14.26 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὁ δὲ παράκλητος τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον... ἐκεῖνος ὑμᾶς διδάξει πάντα καὶ ὑπομνήσει; paraklētos G3875; ekeinos G1565 masculine nominative singular demonstrative; didaxei G1321 future indicative active 3s; hypomnēsei G5279 future indicative active 3s; pneuma G4151 neuter

Force. 'But the Helper, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things and bring to your remembrance all that I have said to you.' The personal noun paraklētos (advocate, helper, legal counselor) is applied to the Spirit. The masculine demonstrative ekeinos is used of grammatically-neuter pneuma, breaking standard Greek agreement, to insist on personal identity. Teaching and reminding are personal actions

John.15.26 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὅταν ἔλθῃ ὁ παράκλητος... ἐκεῖνος μαρτυρήσει περὶ ἐμοῦ; paraklētos G3875; ekeinos G1565; martyreō G3140 future indicative active 3s

Force. 'When the Helper comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father, he will bear witness about me.' Again the masculine ekeinos of neuter pneuma. Bearing witness is a personal speech-act of a witness, not an emanation of a force

John.16.13 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὅταν δὲ ἔλθῃ ἐκεῖνος τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας ὁδηγήσει ὑμᾶς ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ πάση... ὅσα ἀκούσει λαλήσει; ekeinos G1565; hodēgēsei G3594 future indicative active 3s; akousei G191 future indicative active 3s; lalēsei G2980 future indicative active 3s

Force. 'When the Spirit of truth comes, he will guide you into all the truth, for he will not speak on his own authority, but whatever he hears he will speak.' The masculine ekeinos is again paired with neuter pneuma. The Spirit hears and then speaks what he hears, an action sequence only a person can perform. He does not speak from himself but from another, which presupposes a personal sender and a personal hearer

John.16.14 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐκεῖνος ἐμὲ δοξάσει; ekeinos G1565; doxasei G1392 future indicative active 3s

Force. 'He will glorify me, for he will take what is mine and declare it to you.' Glorifying another and declaring to a hearer are personal actions. The mutual glorification within the Trinity (the Son glorifies the Father, the Spirit glorifies the Son) is a personal-relational pattern, not an energetic one

Acts.13.2 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. εἶπεν τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον Ἀφορίσατε δὴ μοι τὸν Βαρναβᾶν καὶ Σαῦλον; eipen G2036 aorist indicative active 3s; aphorise G873 aorist imperative active 2p; moi G1473 dative 1s personal pronoun

Force. 'The Holy Spirit said, Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them.' Direct first-person speech of the Spirit, with the dative pronoun moi ('to me') and the first-person verb proskeklēmai ('I have called'). A force does not say 'me' or 'I.' The Spirit issues an imperative to the church and identifies himself as the one who has called Barnabas and Saul

Acts.16.6 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. κωλυθέντες ὑπὸ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος λαλῆσαι τὸν λόγον ἐν τῇ Ἀσίᾳ; kōlythentes G2967 aorist passive participle

Force. 'Having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia.' The Spirit actively forbids a course of action. Forbidding is a personal volitional act

Acts.16.7 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. οὐκ εἶασεν αὐτοὺς τὸ πνεῦμα Ἰησοῦ; ouk G3756; eiasen G1439 aorist indicative active 3s

Force. 'The Spirit of Jesus did not allow them.' Active prevention of a planned action. The Spirit of Jesus exercises volitional authority over Paul's missionary route. Personal action by a personal agent

Rom.8.26 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα ὑπερεντυγχάνει στεναγμοῖς ἀλαλήτοις; auto G846; hyperentygchanei G5241 present indicative active 3s; stenagmois G4726 dative masculine plural; alalētois G215 dative masculine plural

Force. 'The Spirit himself intercedes for us with groanings too deep for words.' The intensive pronoun auto ('himself') emphasizes personal agency. Intercession is the personal act of presenting petitions on behalf of another. Groaning is an experiential and emotional expression, predicated of the Spirit, that no impersonal force can produce

Rom.8.27 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ὁ ἐραυνῶν τὰς καρδίας οἶδεν τί τὸ φρόνημα τοῦ πνεύματος; phronēma G5427

Force. 'And he who searches hearts knows what is the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will of God.' Phronēma ('mind, way of thinking, disposition') is predicated of the Spirit. A mind belongs to a person, not a power

Eph.4.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. μὴ λυπεῖτε τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον τοῦ θεοῦ; lypeite G3076 present imperative active 2p; pneuma G4151

Force. 'Do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, by whom you were sealed for the day of redemption.' Lypeō ('to grieve, cause sorrow') is a verb of emotional response. Only a person can be grieved. The same verb is used of human sorrow throughout the NT. The command not to grieve presupposes that the object can experience grief; an impersonal force has no capacity for grief

1Cor.12.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. πάντα δὲ ταῦτα ἐνεργεῖ τὸ ἐν καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ πνεῦμα διαιροῦν ἰδίᾳ ἐκάστῳ καθὼς βούλεται; energēi G1754 present indicative active 3s; diairoun G1244 present active participle neuter singular; bouletai G1014 present indicative middle 3s

Force. 'All these are empowered by one and the same Spirit, who apportions to each one individually as he wills.' Boulomai ('to will, to wish, to deliberately choose') is a verb of personal volition. The Spirit chooses how to distribute gifts. Choice belongs to persons, not to forces. A force does not deliberate

1Cor.2.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. τὸ γὰρ πνεῦμα πάντα ἐραυνᾷ καὶ τὰ βάθη τοῦ θεοῦ; eraunaō G2045 present indicative active 3s

Force. 'For the Spirit searches everything, even the depths of God.' Searching is a personal investigative act. The Spirit knows the inner reality of God in a way only an internal personal agent can

1Cor.2.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. οὕτως καὶ τὰ τοῦ θεοῦ οὐδεὶς ἔγνωκεν εἰ μὴ τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ θεοῦ; oida G1492 perfect indicative active 3s

Force. 'So also no one comprehends the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God.' Knowledge ('has known') is predicated of the Spirit. Only a personal subject can know. Paul parallels this to a human spirit knowing a human's own thoughts, an explicit analogy between personal knower and personal knower

Acts.5.3 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. διὰ τί ἐπλήρωσεν ὁ Σατανᾶς τὴν καρδίαν σου ψεύσασθαί σε τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον; pseudomai G5574 aorist middle infinitive

Force. 'Why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit?' Pseudomai ('to lie to') takes a personal object; you cannot lie to a force. Peter then equates this with lying to God in v.4 ('You have not lied to men but to God'), simultaneously establishing the Spirit's personhood and deity

Acts.5.4 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. οὐκ ἐψεύσω ἀνθρώποις ἀλλὰ τῷ θεῷ; theos G2316

Force. 'You have not lied to men but to God.' Direct identification: lying to the Holy Spirit (v.3) is lying to God (v.4). Establishes both the personhood (capable of being lied to) and the deity of the Spirit in a single narrative beat

Matt.28.19 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. βαπτίζοντες αὐτοὺς εἰς τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ πατρὸς καὶ τοῦ υἱοῦ καὶ τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος; onoma G3686 singular accusative

Force. 'Baptizing them in the name (singular onoma) of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit.' Singular 'name' governing three coordinate genitives places the Holy Spirit on the same level of personal identification as the Father and the Son. The Spirit is named alongside two acknowledged persons; the construction would be incoherent if the Spirit were an impersonal force

2Cor.13.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἡ χάρις τοῦ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ καὶ ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἡ κοινωνία τοῦ ἁγίου πνεύματος; koinōnia G2842

Force. 'The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all.' Koinōnia ('fellowship, communion, partnership') is a personal-relational noun. You can have fellowship with a person; you cannot have fellowship with an electric field

Heb.10.29 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς χάριτος ἐνυβρίσας; enybrizō G1796 aorist active participle

Force. 'How much worse punishment do you think will be deserved by the one who has trampled underfoot the Son of God, profaned the blood of the covenant, and outraged the Spirit of grace?' Enybrizō ('to insult, treat with contempt') takes a personal object. You can outrage a person; you cannot outrage a power

Acts.7.51 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ὑμεῖς αἰὶ τῷ πνεύματι τῷ ἁγίῳ ἀντιπίπτετε; antiptō G496 present indicative active 2p

Force. 'You always resist the Holy Spirit.' Antiptō ('to resist, oppose, fall against') takes a personal object. Stephen describes the pattern of OT Israel resisting the Spirit, a relational and volitional conflict between persons (Israel and the Spirit)

Mark.3.29 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὃς δ' ἂν βλασφημήσῃ εἰς τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον; blasphēmō G987 aorist active subjunctive 3s

Force. 'But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit never has forgiveness, but is guilty of an eternal sin.' Blasphemy is speech directed against a personal subject. The category of sin against the Holy Spirit being uniquely unforgivable only makes sense if the Spirit is personally offended; an unforgivable insult against a force is incoherent

1John.2.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. παράκλητον ἔχομεν πρὸς τὸν πατέρα Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν δίκαιον; paraklētos G3875

Force. 'We have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous.' The same noun paraklētos that is applied to the Spirit four times in John 14-16 is here applied to Jesus Christ, an acknowledged person. The term is therefore lexically locked to personal agency, and its application to the Spirit carries the same personal force

1Cor.6.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ναὸς τοῦ ἐν ὑμῖν ἁγίου πνεύματος; naos G3485

Force. 'Your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you.' A naos is the inner sanctuary that houses the personal presence of a deity. The Spirit indwells the believer the way YHWH indwelt the tabernacle and temple, a personal-presence indwelling, not an energetic infusion

Rom.15.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. διὰ τῆς ἀγάπης τοῦ πνεύματος; agapē G26

Force. 'I appeal to you, brothers, by our Lord Jesus Christ and by the love of the Spirit, to strive together with me.' Agapē ('love') is predicated of the Spirit. Love is a personal-relational affection. Only a person can love

John.3.8 · complicates · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, phenomenological-language

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα ὅπου θέλει πνεῖ; thelō G2309 present indicative active 3s; pneō G4154

Force. 'The wind blows where it wishes, and you hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it goes. So it is with everyone who is born of the Spirit.' Wordplay on pneuma (wind/Spirit). The verse uses the wind-image as analogy for the new-birth working of the Spirit. Complicates only at a flat level: the analogy presupposes the Spirit's hidden personal action, and the verb thelō ('wishes') is itself a verb of personal volition

Acts.2.17 · complicates · genre: narrative · figures: metaphor

Key term. ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ πνεύματός μου; ekcheō G1632 future indicative active 1s

Force. 'I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh.' Pouring-out language (quoting Joel 2:28) is liquid imagery, which surface-level critics cite for impersonal-substance reading. Read with the wider canon, the imagery is figurative for the universal sending of the personal Spirit who then teaches, witnesses, and indwells. Pouring is an action God does WITH the Spirit, not a property OF the Spirit

1Thess.5.19 · complicates · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. τὸ πνεῦμα μὴ σβέννυτε; sbennymi G4570 present imperative active 2p

Force. 'Do not quench the Spirit.' Sbennymi is fire-imagery (extinguish a flame), which surface-level critics cite for impersonal-substance reading. The verb is metaphorical: Paul means do not suppress the Spirit's ministry in the gathered church, the same Spirit that v.20 connects to prophecy (a personal communicative act). Complicates only at the figurative-language level

Gen.1.2 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. רוח חַיִּים מְרַחֵף; ruach H7307; merachepheh H7363 participle feminine singular

Force. 'And the Spirit of God was hovering over the face of the waters.' Ruach Elohim ('Spirit of God') performing the action of hovering, an action verb predicated of the Spirit at the dawn of creation. The participle is active and continuous. Personal agency of the Spirit appears in the canon's opening pages

Concordance lemmas traversed

G3875, G4151, G1565, G1321, G5279, G3140, G3594, G2980, G1392, G2036, G1473, G873, G2967, G1439, G5241, G4726, G215, G846, G5427, G3076, G1754, G1244, G1014, G2045, G1492, G5574, G2316, G3686, G2842, G1796, G496, G987, G3485, G26, G2309, G4154, G1632, G4570, G191, G40, G2424, H7307, H7363

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed AD 381; Basil of Caesarea, On the Holy Spirit (NPNF2 Vol 8); Athanasius, Letters to Serapion; Gregory of Nazianzus, Fifth Theological Oration on the Holy Spirit · affirms · verified

"Constantinopolitan Creed: 'the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of life, who proceeds from the Father, who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified, who spoke through the prophets'"

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 687-741 on the Holy Spirit (vatican.va) · affirms · verified

“CCC 691: 'Holy Spirit is the proper name of the one whom we adore and glorify with the Father and the Son.' The Spirit is named, adored, and glorified as a distinct divine person”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession Article I, Of God (bookofconcord.org); Formula of Concord on the Person and Work of the Spirit · affirms · verified

“Augsburg I: 'there are three Persons, of the same essence and power, who also are coeternal, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost.' The Spirit is confessed as a coeternal person”

anglican · 39 Articles, Article V, Of the Holy Ghost (churchofengland.org) · affirms · unverified

“Article V: 'The Holy Ghost, proceeding from the Father and the Son, is of one substance, majesty, and glory, with the Father and the Son, very and eternal God”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith 2.3; Belgic Confession Article 11; Heidelberg Catechism Q&A 53 · affirms · unverified

“WCF 2.3: 'In the unity of the Godhead there be three Persons, of one substance, power, and eternity: God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Ghost.' Heidelberg Q53: the Holy Spirit is co-eternal God with Father and Son, given to be the believer's comforter”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article IV, Of the Holy Ghost (umc.org) · affirms · verified

“Article IV: 'The Holy Ghost, proceeding from the Father and the Son, is of one substance, majesty, and glory with the Father and the Son, very and eternal God.' Wesley's abridgement preserves the Anglican formula verbatim”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession 1632 Article 1, Of God and the Creation of All Things; Schleithem is silent on pneumatology specifically · affirms · unverified

“Dordrecht confesses one God in three persons including the Holy Spirit. The Anabaptist mainstream affirmed Nicene-Constantinopolitan pneumatology even where Schleithem minimalism omits explicit Trinitarian formulae”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 2, The One True God, and Truth 7-8, The Baptism in the Holy Spirit (ag.org) · affirms · unverified

“AG Truth 2: the Godhead exists eternally in three persons, Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. Pentecostalism is built on the personal indwelling and gifting ministry of the Spirit, presupposing personhood”

eastern_orthodox · OCA, The Orthodox Faith, on the Holy Spirit (oca.org); Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed as recited in Orthodox liturgy · affirms · verified

“Orthodoxy confesses the Symbol of Faith with the original procession clause: the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the giver of life, who proceeds from the Father, who together with the Father and the Son is worshipped and glorified”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/14-26.htm>

“John 14:26: paraklētos G3875 (personal noun, advocate/helper); masculine ekeinos G1565 used of neuter pneuma G4151, breaking grammatical agreement; didaxei (will teach) and hypomnēsei (will remind) are personal actions”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/16-13.htm>

“John 16:13: ekeinos masculine demonstrative of neuter pneuma; hodēgēsei (will guide) and lalēsei (will speak) future indicative active 3s. Spirit hears and speaks what he hears, action sequence requiring personhood”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/3875.htm>

“paraklētos G3875: 'legal advocate who pleads another's cause; intercessor; helper'. Five NT occurrences: four of the Holy Spirit (John 14:16, 14:26, 15:26, 16:7), one of Christ (1 John 2:1). Lexically locked to personal agency”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/13-2.htm>

“Acts 13:2: 'the Holy Spirit said (eipen G2036)... Set apart for me (moi G1473 dative 1s) Barnabas and Saul.' First-person speech of the Spirit with personal pronoun moi. A force does not say 'me'”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/8-26.htm>

“Rom 8:26: auto G846 ('himself') the Spirit hyperentychanei G5241 (intercedes) with stenagmois G4726 (groanings). Personal pronoun, personal action, experiential emotive language. Synantilambanetai G4878 (joins to help)”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/ephesians/4-30.htm>

“Eph 4:30: lypeite G3076 (do not grieve) present imperative active 2p. Lypeō is the standard NT verb for emotional sorrow. Only a person can be grieved. Command presupposes capacity for grief in the object”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/12-11.htm

“1 Cor 12:11: the Spirit apportions (diairoun G1244) gifts 'as he wills' (bouletai G1014). Boulomai is the verb of personal deliberate volition. Choice requires a chooser”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/16-7.htm>

“Acts 16:7: 'the Spirit of Jesus did not allow them' (ouk eiasen G1439). Active prevention of a planned action. Volitional authority over Paul's missionary route, a personal-agent decision”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_P21.HTM

“CCC on the Holy Spirit: 'Holy Spirit is the proper name of the one whom we adore and glorify with the Father and the Son.' The Spirit has a proper name, is adored, and is glorified, all marks of personhood”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg Confession Article I: there are three Persons of the same essence and power, coeternal: the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost. The Spirit confessed as a coeternal person”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.umc.org/en/content/articles-of-religion>

“Methodist Article IV: 'The Holy Ghost, proceeding from the Father and the Son, is of one substance, majesty, and glory with the Father and the Son, very and eternal God.' Wesley preserves the Anglican formula”

supports · category: tradition_primary ·

<https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/doctrine-scripture/the-symbol-of-faith/the-holy-spirit>

“OCA on the Spirit: 'When the Spirit of Truth comes, He will guide you into all the truth... He will glorify Me' (Jn 16:12-15). Personal pronouns and personal actions throughout”